

SNL ESG OCR File Path Guide

Detailed guide for changing input folders and output folders for the invoice OCR pipeline.

1. Quick Answer

Most file paths are controlled by one local configuration file: **config/settings.yaml**. Edit that file when you want permanent path changes. Use the command-line **--input** option only when you want to temporarily override the input folder for one run.

Need	Where to change it
Permanent input folder	config/settings.yaml, under paths.raw_json_scope1/scope2/water/waste
Permanent output folders	config/settings.yaml, under paths.bronze_output, silver_excel_output, review_checkpoint_output, etc.
One-time input folder	Run main.py with --input "C:/path/to/json_folder"
Review app data locations	The review app reads the configured bronze, silver, checkpoint, and upload folders

2. The File To Edit

Open this file in the project:

```
C:\Users\My PC\Desktop\snl-esg-ocr\config\settings.yaml
```

This file is intentionally local to your computer. The repository also contains **config/settings.example.yaml**, which is only the shared template. Use the example file as a reference, but edit **config/settings.yaml** for actual runs.

Current local settings

```
app:
  name: invoice_platform
  environment: dev

paths:
  raw_json_scope1: "data/source/scope1"
  raw_json_scope2: "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/raw_json"
  raw_json_water: "data/source/water"
  raw_json_waste: "data/source/waste"

  bronze_output: "data/bronze"
  silver_excel_output: "data/silver"
  review_checkpoint_output: "data/output/checkpoints"
  manual_data_entry_uploads: "data/manual_uploads"
  category_checkpoint_dirs: true
  gold_output: "data/gold"
```

3. Input Paths

Input paths tell the pipeline where the raw Azure Document Intelligence JSON files are stored. Each category has its own input setting. The selected category decides which input path is used.

Category	Setting	Used by command
Scope 1	raw_json_scope1	main.py --category scope1

Category	Setting	Used by command
Scope 2	raw_json_scope2	main.py --category scope2
Water	raw_json_water	main.py --category water
Waste	raw_json_waste	main.py --category waste

The input folder must contain .json files. The project does not copy these raw files into the bronze folder; it reads them from the configured source folder and records each source file path in the output.

Local folder example

```
paths:
  raw_json_scope2: "data/source"
```

With this setting, put Scope 2 JSON files here:

```
C:\Users\My PC\Desktop\snl-esg-ocr\data\source
```

SharePoint or synced folder example

```
paths:
  raw_json_scope2: "C:/Users/My PC/SharePoint/raw_json"
```

Use forward slashes in YAML paths on Windows. They are easier to read and avoid escape-character problems.

4. Output Paths

Output paths tell the pipeline where to create generated CSV files, Excel files, review checkpoint CSV files, manual upload files, and future gold-layer outputs.

Setting	Purpose	Current value
bronze_output	Bronze CSV output folder	data/bronze
silver_excel_output	Final numbered Silver Excel workbook folder	data/silver
review_checkpoint_output	Review checkpoint CSV folder	data/output/checkpoints
manual_data_entry_uploads	Unsupported invoice files uploaded through the app	data/manual_uploads
gold_output	Gold output folder reserved for later layers	data/gold

Move all outputs to a Desktop folder

```
paths:
  bronze_output: "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/esg_outputs/bronze"
  silver_excel_output: "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/esg_outputs/silver"
  review_checkpoint_output: "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/esg_outputs/checkpoints"
  manual_data_entry_uploads: "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/esg_outputs/manual_uploads"
  gold_output: "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/esg_outputs/gold"
```

Keep outputs inside the project

```
paths:
  bronze_output: "data/bronze"
  silver_excel_output: "data/silver"
  review_checkpoint_output: "data/output/checkpoints"
  manual_data_entry_uploads: "data/manual_uploads"
  gold_output: "data/gold"
```

5. What Files Are Produced

The exact filenames depend on the category. For Scope 2, the default generated files are:

```
data/bronze/scope2_bronze.csv

data/silver/01_scope2_silver_reviewed.xlsx
data/silver/02_scope2_silver_normalized.xlsx
data/silver/03_scope2_silver_curated.xlsx
data/silver/04_scope2_silver_aggregated.xlsx
data/silver/05_scope2_silver_proration_calculation.xlsx
data/silver/06_scope2_silver_proration_split.xlsx
data/silver/07_scope2_silver_prorated.xlsx
```

For other categories, replace scope2 in the filename with scope1, water, or waste. For example, Water bronze output is water_bronze.csv.

Review checkpoint outputs

Because category_checkpoint_dirs is currently true, checkpoints are grouped by category. For Scope 2, they are written under data/output/checkpoints/scope2.

```
data/output/checkpoints/scope2/step_0_manual_data_entry_queue.csv
data/output/checkpoints/scope2/step_0_manual_data_entry_decisions_checkpoint.csv
data/output/checkpoints/scope2/step_1_field_quality_checkpoint.csv
data/output/checkpoints/scope2/step_2_review_summary_checkpoint.csv
data/output/checkpoints/scope2/step_3_review_issues_checkpoint.csv
data/output/checkpoints/scope2/step_4_manual_review_decisions_checkpoint.csv
data/output/checkpoints/scope2/step_5_approved_silver_checkpoint.csv
```

If category_checkpoint_dirs is changed to false, all category checkpoint files are written directly inside review_checkpoint_output. Keeping it true is usually safer because it prevents categories from overwriting each other's checkpoint files.

6. How To Run

Run with paths from settings.yaml

```
cd "C:\Users\My PC\Desktop\snl-esg-ocr"
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe main.py --category scope2
```

Valid category values are scope1, scope2, water, and waste.

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe main.py --category scope1
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe main.py --category scope2
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe main.py --category water
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe main.py --category waste
```

Run with a one-time input override

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe main.py --category scope2 --input "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/raw_json"
```

The --input value overrides only the input folder for that run. Output folders still come from settings.yaml.

Start the review app

```
.\.venv\Scripts\streamlit.exe run review_app.py
```

The review app reads the same configured bronze, silver, checkpoint, and manual upload folders. If you change output paths, restart the app so it loads the new settings.

7. Recommended Path Patterns

Scenario	Recommended setting
Testing inside the project	Use relative paths such as data/source and data/silver
Daily work with synced raw OCR files	Use an absolute raw_json path pointing to the synced folder
Sharing outputs with a team	Use absolute output paths inside a synced team folder
Avoiding category conflicts	Leave category_checkpoint_dirs set to true
Temporary experiment	Use --input for the input folder and leave settings.yaml unchanged

8. Rules For Editing YAML Paths

- Keep paths inside quotation marks when they contain spaces.
- Use forward slashes, for example C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/raw_json.
- Indent child settings with two spaces under paths.
- Do not use tabs in YAML.
- Make sure the folder exists or that the pipeline has permission to create it.
- Close output CSV or Excel files before running the pipeline again.

9. Step-By-Step Example

This example changes Scope 2 input files to a SharePoint folder and writes all generated outputs to a Desktop folder.

- 1 Open config/settings.yaml.
- 2 Change raw_json_scope2 to the folder that contains your OCR JSON files.
- 3 Change bronze_output, silver_excel_output, review_checkpoint_output, manual_data_entry_uploads, and gold_output if you want generated files somewhere else.
- 4 Save settings.yaml.
- 5 Run main.py with --category scope2.
- 6 Check the bronze CSV and silver Excel files in the output folders.

```
paths:
  raw_json_scope2: "C:/Users/My PC/SharePoint/raw_json"

  bronze_output: "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/esg_outputs/bronze"
  silver_excel_output: "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/esg_outputs/silver"
  review_checkpoint_output: "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/esg_outputs/checkpoints"
  manual_data_entry_uploads: "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/esg_outputs/manual_uploads"
  category_checkpoint_dirs: true
  gold_output: "C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/esg_outputs/gold"

.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe main.py --category scope2
```

10. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause	Fix
No JSON files found	Input path points to the wrong folder or folder is empty	Check raw_json_ or rerun with --input
YAML error	Bad indentation, missing quote, or tab character	Use two spaces under paths and quote paths with spaces

Problem	Likely cause	Fix
Cannot write CSV or Excel	Output file is open in Excel or locked	Close the output file and run again
Review app shows old files	App cache or old running session	Click refresh in the app or restart Streamlit
Checkpoints mixed between categories	category_checkpoint_dirs disabled	Set category_checkpoint_dirs: true
One category uses wrong input	Running without the intended --category	Pass --category scope1/scope2/water/waste explicitly

11. Final Checklist

- config/settings.yaml exists and contains the desired paths.
- The selected raw_json_ folder contains .json files.
- Output folders are correct and writable.
- category_checkpoint_dirs is true unless you intentionally want one shared checkpoint folder.
- The command includes the correct --category value.
- Any previously generated CSV or Excel files are closed before rerunning.

Generated for the local workspace at C:/Users/My PC/Desktop/snl-esg-ocr.